
File Case #13

Case ID: 250N **Case Title:** The "'Spark' Hunter" Case **Date:** Spate of crimes in 2023
Status: Closed

Crime Summary: Several women reported being robbed by a man they met through **"Spark," a popular dating app**. The man would meet them at their apartments, and after gaining their trust, would subtly **drug them with a benzodiazepine** in their drink and steal valuables.

Modus Operandi (M.O.): The suspect created **fake profiles** on "Spark" using model photos. He was charming and convincing. He always used the same opening line: **"Do you believe in destiny, or should I walk by again?"** After each robbery, he **deleted the profile** and created a new one.

Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect: Esteban "El Encantador" (The Charmer) Pardo**, a con artist with a history of fraud.
- **Victim(s):** At least 6 women.

Key Evidence:

- The **identical behavioral pattern** and **opening line**, reported by all victims.
- Analysis of drug residue in the victims' glasses.
- Despite using fake profiles, one victim recalled the suspect mentioning **working near a specific area of the city**.
- The suspect made a mistake: he used the **same coffee shop WiFi network** to create two of his fake profiles on different weeks.

Forensic Analysis: The cybercrime team worked with "Spark" to identify accounts created from the **same device MAC address**, even if the IPs were different. They cross-referenced this information with the **coffee shop's geolocation data**, which allowed them to obtain a short list of devices. One of the victims **recognized Esteban Pardo** in a series of photographs.

Resolution: Esteban Pardo was arrested. Several of the stolen items were found in his possession. The digital evidence, combined with victim recognition, led to his **conviction**.